

Emergency Action Plan

For suspected case of Decompression Sickness (DCS)

Signs and Symptoms of DCS

1. Fatigue
2. Lack of Coordination
3. Numbness
4. Joint and muscle pain
5. Weakness
6. Clouded judgment
7. Rash
8. Paralysis (extreme)

Emergency Action Plan

1. A suspected case of DCS may arise for a couple of reasons
 - a. Diver complaining of the common signs and symptoms of DCS
 - b. Diver mismanaging or negligent to build up of Nitrogen, especially on a multiple dive day
 - c. Underwater emergency forcing diver(s) to suddenly ascend
2. In a confirmed or suspected case of DCS, take the following steps (once diver is out of water)
 - a. Contact Scuba School front desk +501 226-2886 and emergency medical services (EMS) +501 223-3292
 - i. Do not attempt to recompress a victim underwater
 - ii. Recompression via hyperbaric chamber is likely necessary - to be handled by professionals
 - b. Give patient oxygen. 100% is best, but nitrox or enriched air is preferable to nothing
 - c. Keep a breathing patient lying level
 - i. Lay a non-breathing patient on back for rescue breaths and CPR
 - d. Provide AB-CABS cycle of care
 - i. Monitor airway, breathing, and circulation
 - e. Once patient is responsive, stable, and out of immediate danger, ask them the following questions from the PADI Diving Accident Management Work Slate
 - i. Were you scuba diving today or breathing compressed gas?
 - ii. Did you make a forced or rapid ascent?
 - iii. How deep did you go?
 - iv. What was your bottom time?
 - v. Do you feel excessively tired?
 - vi. Where do you hurt?
 - vii. Do you feel dizzy?
 - viii. Does any part of you feel numb or tingle?
 - ix. Are you having difficulty breathing?